

A U.S. Court
Reliably Aids
Trump’s Aims

Justice Dept. Is Bringing
Cases to Texas Judge

By ZACH MONTAGUE and MATTATHIAS SCHWARTZ

President Trump’s Justice Department had a problem. Judge after judge was rejecting its demands that hospitals across the country turn over internal records of transgender care provided to children.

By the end of April, federal judges in Boston, Philadelphia, Pittsburgh, Los Angeles and Seattle had either quashed or substantially pared the administration’s demands that hospitals send patient records to the federal government.

But the administration did not give up. Instead, in April, it went to the Northern District of Texas’ Fort Worth courthouse, where nearly all cases go directly to the district’s chief judge, Reed O’Connor, or a second judge, Mark T. Pittman, who was appointed by Mr. Trump.

There were no hospitals in Texas that offered the transgender care at issue — state lawmakers banned gender-affirming care for minors in Texas in 2023. But the Justice Department asked the Texas court to enforce a subpoena to the Rhode Island Hospital, arguing that its nationwide investigation of such medical care was “being carried out in the Northern District of Texas.”

That was enough for Judge O’Connor, an appointee of President George W. Bush who has built a reputation as a conservative stalwart and became the district’s chief judge last August.

He granted the motion, clearing the way for the hospital to turn over a variety of personal data, including the names and Social Security numbers of minors who had received treatment.

“The subpoena’s demands are reasonable,” he wrote.

Most of the country’s 94 district courts assign cases randomly across all of their judges.

Northern Texas, where Judge O’Connor sits, does things its own way. It assigns cases to judges based on the courthouse within the district where the lawsuit is initially filed. Some courthouses are staffed by just one or two judges, meaning litigants can easily engage in “judge shopping” — filing their case in a particular courthouse and knowing to a certainty or near-certainty which judge will decide it.

In four of Northern Texas’ seven courthouses, one judge appointed by Mr. Trump hears all of the cases. In a fifth courthouse, all the cases go to Judge O’Connor. In a sixth — Fort Worth — 90 percent of the caseload is split between Judge O’Connor and Judge Pittman.

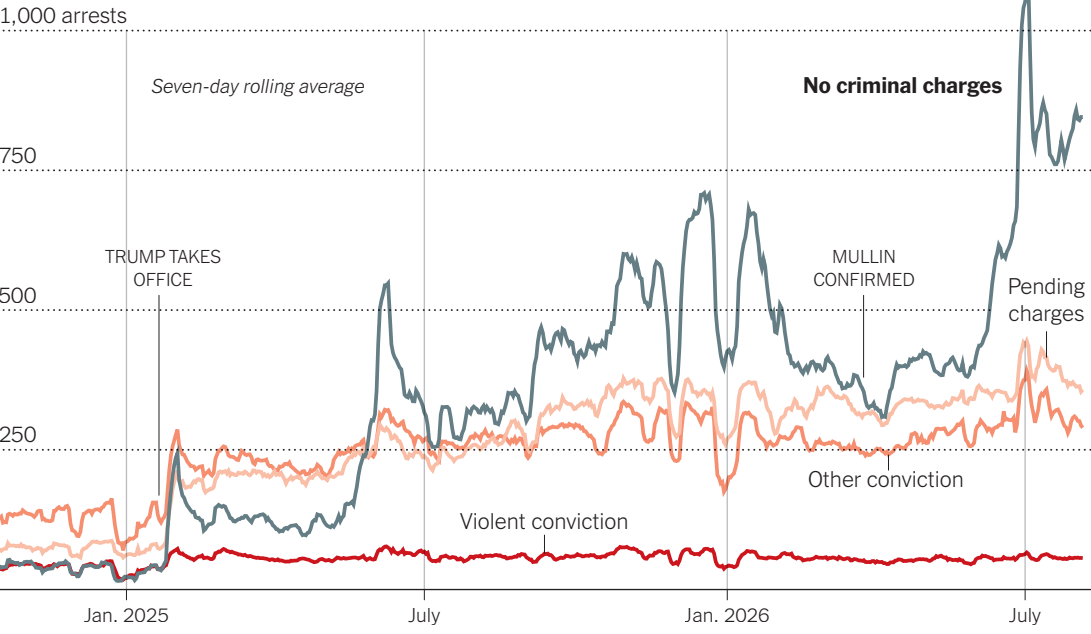
Of the district’s nine active-status judges, eight were appointed by Republican presidents — six of them by Mr. Trump. There are other districts in the country

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ICE Widens Focus to Those With No Criminal Record

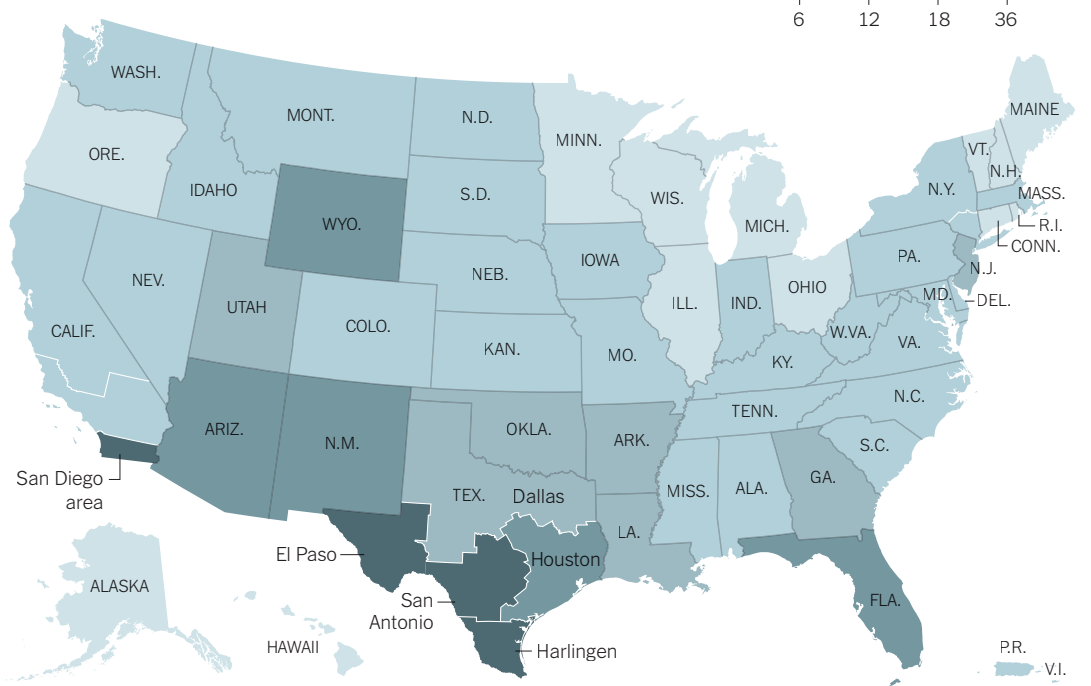
A surge in immigration arrests includes spouses of U.S. citizens, those who had entered legally and were pursuing asylum, and others with temporary legal status. Page A12.

ICE arrests of people with no criminal history have risen fastest



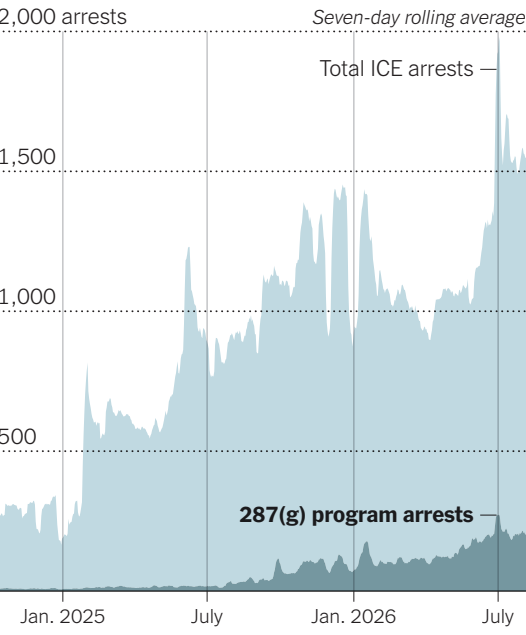
Note: The chart shows ICE arrests of people the agency recorded as having a past criminal conviction, criminal charges or neither. Violent crimes were determined based on categories from the National Crime Information Center.

July arrests were highest along the southern border

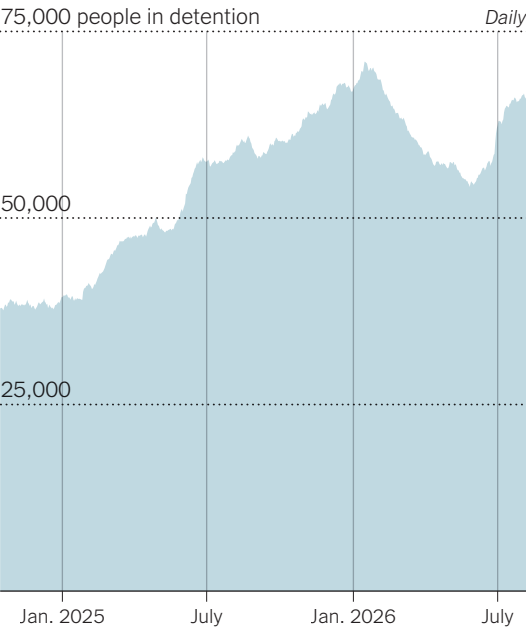


Note: The map shows arrests by state and territory, and by ICE field office in California, New York and Texas, where more detailed data is available.

Local partners are carrying out
a growing share of ICE arrests



The number of people held in ICE
detention ticked back up this summer



ALBERT SUN AND ALLISON MCCANN/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Deportees Flown to Africa
Tell of Shackles and Agony

10 Detainees Say They Experienced or Saw
Abusive Treatment by ICE Agents

This article is by Emmanuel Akinwotu, Pranav Baskar, Genevieve Glatsky and Hamed Aleaziz.

MARSHALL, Liberia — Leonardo Sánchez wailed in pain for hours on the deportation flight from Louisiana to West Africa, he and six other detainees said.

He’d been cuffed around his wrists and ankles. A chain around his waist dug into his grossly protruding abdomen — the result of years-old wounds and surgeries that doctors said left his intestines barely inside his body.

Mr. Sánchez, a 49-year-old Cuban, begged for medical attention from several of the Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents on the aircraft.

“I was in pain, crying like a little kid,” he said. But the agents wouldn’t remove his chains or let him use the toilet, he and other detainees said. He wet himself.

Like many of the more than two dozen deportees on the flight with him, Mr. Sánchez said he did not know where he was being taken. Several panicked when they suspected it was Liberia, after one saw it written on a paper held by an ICE official in Louisiana.

When some protested, they were beaten by agents, five of the deportees said. Some were slammed to the ground or struck with blows, several said. One showed cuts along his wrists and bruises around his neck, which he said he received after resisting getting on the plane. Another said some deportees were left screaming in pain.

The planeload of deportees, which arrived in Liberia this month, carried the first of 1,200 people expected to be sent to the West African country by the United States over the next year. The arrangement is one of the largest in a growing number of deals the Trump administration has made to send deportees — including people with court orders protecting them from being sent back to their home countries — to nations halfway across the world where they have no ties.

In recent weeks, the White House has pushed to expand these so-called third-country deportation efforts and increase the number of people expelled from the United States, according to a U.S. official. Last month, ICE arrests jumped to nearly 50,000, and the administration has focused on deporting people who have been able to remain in the country for years with court orders protecting them from being sent home, another official added.

The New York Times interviewed 10 of the deportees on the flight to Liberia, all of whom described a harrowing journey that included months in detention in the United States and a panicked 14-hour expulsion to Africa, in which agents wrestled and shackled frightened detainees.

Several spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of reprisals. All of them said they experienced or witnessed what they described as abusive or violent treatment by

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How 47 States
Cornered Meta
On Teen Safety

By CECILIA KANG and ELI TAN

WASHINGTON — Six days before the start of a federal trial over online child safety, C.J. Mahoney, Meta’s chief legal officer, traveled to Nashville on Aug. 6 to meet with lawyers for about a dozen states. He wanted to broker an enormous settlement, two people familiar with the conversation said.

Meta had already suffered losses in court this year over claims it created addictive products that harmed young users. Mark Zuckerberg had endured a full day of grilling on the witness stand during one of those trials. (“You’re mischaracterizing this,” he kept repeating.) He was likely to be questioned again at the federal trial in California, in which a coalition of states had sued Meta, arguing that the company had contributed to a national child mental health crisis.

Over bagels and coffee in an Art Deco office on Tennessee’s Capitol grounds, Mr. Mahoney presented his terms, which Mr. Zuckerberg had personally approved, according to four people familiar with the negotiations. Meta would pay the states up to \$19 billion and make changes to its platforms to improve teen safety. Some of the payment would be withheld unless all states joined and other social media companies also settled.

For the state attorneys general in the room, the offer was intriguing. They had been negotiating with the Silicon Valley giant for months with little progress, the people said. On Tuesday, 47 states — two had dropped out of the lawsuit — along with the District of Columbia and several territories agreed to a settlement worth roughly \$17 billion.

“There’s a saying here in Tennessee,” Jonathan Skrmetti, the

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Germany Seeks
To Curb Access
Of Its Far Right

By CHRISTOPHER F. SCHUETZE and JIM TANKERSLEY

BERLIN — Government leaders across Germany are publicly and privately exploring ways to curb the power of the far-right Alternative for Germany party, or AfD, if it wins control of a state government in elections on Sept. 6.

The officials’ efforts, detailed in interviews and in statements by top officials, include attempts to throttle the routine sharing of certain classified information with state-level intelligence services should the AfD win control of them. They also involve less onerous measures aimed at policy matters. The planning is driven partly out of fear that AfD officials could pass national secrets to Russia, to which the party maintains close ties.

The AfD is poised to win the most votes in Sept. 6 elections in the state of Saxony-Anhalt in Germany’s east. If it secures enough seats to form a governing coalition by itself, it will become the first far-right party since World War II to hold power in Germany.

Governing a state would typically grant a party access to national secrets, including about intelligence and security.

Many officials seeking to curb the AfD’s power see it as a threat to German democracy and national security, and say their plans are necessary to safeguard the country. Protection of democracy is a particularly sensitive issue in Germany, which after World War II designed its institutions to prevent extreme parties like the Nazis from ever returning to power.

The AfD’s rival parties consider it extreme. No other major party in Germany will work with it to form a government at the state or national level, a collusion that is

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In Spain, 10 P.M. Was Dinnertime. For Many, It’s Now Bedtime.

By JONATHAN WOLFE

MADRID — For generations, dinnertime for the Terrazas family, as in many households in Spain, was late. It usually began after 10 p.m. and often stretched past midnight.

But now, Antonio Terrazas, a tax adviser in Madrid, says his family sits down to eat around 9 p.m. When they dine out, they’re also eating earlier, and have noticed their friends are, too.

“At first it was strange. We’d look at each other like, ‘*Madre mía*, who would believe that we’d be seated at a restaurant and eating at 9 o’clock?’” Mr. Terrazas said. “But not anymore.”

In Spain, known for its night-owl energy, a quiet revolution appears to be unfolding in one of its best-known cultural institutions: the late-night dinner.

Spaniards have long eaten later than people elsewhere in Europe, a tradition that many see as part of the national identity. By custom, families gather around their dinner tables late at night and restaurants remain filled long past the time when much of the industrialized world has turned in.

Spain held fast to the practice even as experts debated whether it was a drag on the economy, producing a work force that was more tired and less productive

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EMILIO PARRA DOIZTUA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Bucking tradition, reservations in Spain are often at 9 (or gasp) 8.

NATIONAL A9-13, 16

Threat to Sending Ballots

If the Postal Service is allowed to carry out curbs on mail voting, the rule could affect battleground races. PAGE A16

World’s ‘Salad Bowl’ Is Wilting

After the cyclosporiasis outbreak cut demand for lettuce, California growers are mulching their crops. PAGE A9



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Democratic Socialists on Tour

The success of progressive candidates in the United States is inspiring Latin American leftists struggling after a string of regional losses. PAGE A4

U.S. Attacks Iranian Island

The strike, the first in a month, appeared to be limited rather than a resumption of large-scale bombing. PAGE A6

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A Singer and a Scamp

Jaye P. Morgan made a splash on the charts in the 1950s and became a bawdy game-show regular. She was 94. PAGE B8

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Building India’s Dream City

The chief minister of Andhra Pradesh State has envisioned a brand-new, world-class capital, and with 25,000 workers, he is constructing it. PAGE B1

The New Petroleum Partner

President Trump’s Venezuelan oil deal relies on an influential, divisive businessman whose family company is tied to the government. PAGE B1

An Elusive Threat to Livestock

Traps in the Southwest to trace screw-worm flies, which can be deadly to cattle, are turning up empty. Is that good news, or bad? PAGE B1

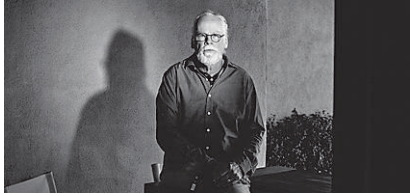
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Love in a Cynical Age

The British romantic comedy “Finding Emily” pokes fun at a range of stereotypical Gen Z behaviors. PAGE C1

Tackling Nonfictional Crime

The novelist Michael Connelly says the Zodiac killer is also responsible for another famous unsolved case. PAGE C1



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How Athletes View Activism

Ten years after Colin Kaepernick’s bold gesture, the former N.F.L. quarterback stands alone in his approach. PAGE D1

On Edge Before the U.S. Open

Qualifying matches, which are free to fans, represent a quest for financial survival for the competitors. PAGE D2

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Lindsey Smith Taillie

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